

that there is not a direct correlation between house prices and rents. A room will typically rent out for between £300 and £400 per month. This is the case if the house is in Bristol or Stoke-on-Trent

A 4-bed HMO in Bristol may be £350,000, whereas in Stoke-on-Trent it is just £80,000. It makes sense to buy in cheaper areas as the rents do not change that much

?Agents or advertise

Finding the types of properties that tick all of the five boxes is very difficult when you start off, but it gets easy in time. When I started off I used to buy from agents. I then became a 'professional' so would no longer buy from agents but instead would advertise and do leaflet drops. I then became seasoned and went back to buying from agents. Today, I find most of my deals from networking, speaking engagements and agents. The moral of the story is to never turn your nose up at agents because they have access to more motivated sellers than you could count

In 2011, I became an estate agent just to make friends, network and get free training. I only did it for three months but I learned three things

- Most estate agents are not property experts, but sales people that (1
.happen to sell property
- Making friends with agents is very valuable because they do come (2
.across excellent property
- !Having a real job is tough. Three months is more than enough (3

I have also bought some excellent properties from deal-sourcing companies. This can be a great way forward and very time-effective, and it also mirrors how they found the deal. However, be careful because there are many bad